

SCOPE & SEQUENCE

English Language Arts *Grades 7 & 8*

Core literature units · Writing workshop · Wilson Just Words word study

INSTRUCTOR

Mr. Samuel Carlos
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SCHOOL YEAR

2026-2027
Quarters 1-4 · 36 weeks

ALIGNMENT

CCSS ELA Grades 7-8
Core Six instructional framework



How the Program Works

Every class period carries two instructional engines. The first half of each period drives the core literature and writing unit: guided reading, evidence-based writing, and discussion built on the Core Six strategies. The second half delivers Wilson Just Words, an explicit Tier 2 decoding and spelling curriculum that closes foundational gaps while the literary units push grade-level analysis. A daily Morning Edit warm-up opens each session with hands-on conventions practice.

ANATOMY OF A CLASS PERIOD

OPENING · ~10 MIN

Morning Edit

Students correct a 10-error paragraph drawn from the current unit's world. Daily, cumulative conventions practice.

FIRST HALF · CORE UNIT

Literature & Writing Block

Guided reading, the weekly assignment, and one-on-one feedback conferences, following the three-session cycle below.

SECOND HALF · TIER 2

Wilson Just Words

Multisensory word study: sound drills, syllable concepts, word and sentence reading, and dictation. Sequence on page 7.

The Weekly Three-Session Cycle

- **Session 1 (80 min):** Guided reading of the week's text, assignment launched, first feedback conferences begin.
- **Session 2 (80 min):** Assignment re-taught, independent work, conferences continue. Most students finish and revise.
- **Session 3 (Fri · 40 min):** Catch-up and revision. Finished students move to independent reading journals or extra credit writing.
- **Grading:** Initial grades by conference before the weekend; final grades entered the following Session 1.

Assignment Design Commitments

- Weekly readings are completable in about 25 minutes: roughly 1,000 words in Grade 7 and 1,500 words in Grade 8.
- Every challenging text ships with a simplified version, a vocabulary scaffold, or an audio recording.
- Modified and ELL Development versions are part of the standard set, never afterthoughts.
- Formats repeat across the year, so cognitive load stays on the content, not the directions.

THE CORE SIX INSTRUCTIONAL STRATEGIES

Reading for Meaning

Pre-reading statements; students hunt for supporting or refuting evidence.

Compare & Contrast

Top Hat organizers that end in evaluation, not just description.

Inductive Learning

Students sort and categorize unit vocabulary before and during reading.

Circle of Knowledge

Structured discussion using the Q-SPACE questioning framework.

Write to Learn

Three tiers of writing: provisional, readable, and polished.

Vocabulary CODE

Connect, Organize, Deep-process, Exercise.

RHYTHM OF EVERY QUARTER

Launch

Inductive Learning vocabulary sort opens the unit and surfaces prior knowledge.

Build

Weekly reading and writing assignments with same-week feedback conferences.

Discuss

Circle of Knowledge seminar at the heart of the unit.

Produce

A polished quarter product through a full draft, feedback, and revision cycle.

Writing arc by grade. Grade 7 solidifies sentence-level craft and builds to evidence-based paragraphs across the year. Grade 8 moves from sentences up through full multi-paragraph essays and stories. Rubrics are element-by-element: each required sentence or paragraph has its own criteria row.

7 Seventh Grade English Language Arts

Memoir, poetry, nonfiction science writing, and original fiction. Writing focus: strong sentences building to evidence-based paragraphs.

SCHEDULE

Mon · Wed · Fri

READING

TARGET

~1,000 words / week

Q1 Red Scarf Girl & Personal Narrative

ANCHOR TEXT *Red Scarf Girl*, Ji-li Jiang's memoir of China's Cultural Revolution.

PRODUCT Personal narrative essay told from a turning-point moment, with a full revision cycle.

WORD STUDY Context clues; dictionary skills; inductive vocabulary sorts.

RL.1-3 RL.6 W.3 W.5 SL.1 **Reading for Meaning**

Top Hat

Q2 Robert Frost & Writing Poetry

ANCHOR TEXT Poems by Robert Frost, Edgar Allan Poe, and a diverse contemporary anthology.

PRODUCT Original poem collection (6-8 poems) with an artist's statement, shared at a class reading.

WORD STUDY Figurative language; connotation and denotation; sound devices.

RL.4 RL.5 W.3-4 L.5 SL.4 **Inductive Learning**

Vocabulary CODE

Q3 Brain Science & Writing to Learn

ANCHOR TEXT The Phineas Gage case, Oliver Sacks case-study excerpts, and brain science articles.

PRODUCT Informational and explanatory writing that uses writing as a tool for thinking through nonfiction.

WORD STUDY Greek and Latin roots in scientific vocabulary.

RI.1-4 W.2 W.9 L.4 SL.1 **Write to Learn**

Circle of Knowledge

Q4 Story Writing Workshop

ANCHOR TEXT Short fiction mentor texts studied in class as models of storytelling craft.

PRODUCT An original short story, planned, drafted, revised twice, and published in a class anthology.

WORD STUDY Grammar workshops run on student drafts: usage, conventions, style.

W.3-5 L.1-3 RL.3 SL.6 **Write to Learn**

Compare & Contrast

Grading Scale

A	B	C	D	F
88.5%+	78.5-88.4	68.5-78.4	58.5-68.4	0-58.4

How Work Is Assessed

- One weekly paper assignment, graded through one-on-one conferences with a revision window before grades finalize.
- One polished quarter product, scored with element-by-element rubrics tied to each required sentence and paragraph.
- Just Words unit tests, plus a midterm and final cumulative assessment (page 7).

Running all year: daily Morning Edit conventions practice, weekly homework in familiar Template A and Template B formats, independent reading journals, and the Wilson Just Words word study block in the second half of every period (sequence on page 7).

Grade 7 Week by Week

Each quarter runs nine weeks: roughly six weeks anchored in the text, then a three-week production window for the quarter product.

Cream-shaded rows mark the production window.

	QUARTER 1 Red Scarf Girl	QUARTER 2 Frost & Poetry	QUARTER 3 Brain Science	QUARTER 4 Story Workshop
W1	Unit launch; memoir genre; pre-reading statements (Reading for Meaning)	What is poetry? Sound devices; close reading of short poems	Launch; the Phineas Gage case; nonfiction reading strategies	Story architecture: arc, scene, conflict; mentor text mini-lessons
W2	Cultural Revolution context; inductive vocab sort; ch. 1-3	Frost: imagery, rhythm, and the turn ("The Road Not Taken" and others)	Gage chapters; brain anatomy vocabulary (Greek & Latin roots)	Character building; voice and point-of-view experiments
W3	Ch. 4-6; character analysis of Ji-li's choices; learning logs	Poe: "The Raven"; rhyme, meter, and mood; figurative language sort	Oliver Sacks case studies; how writers explain science to lay readers	Setting and worldbuilding; opening scene drafted
W4	Ch. 7-9; theme development; 4-2-1 reflections	Diverse poetic voices; form vs. free verse; structure analysis	Text structure in science writing; comparing two explanations (Top Hat)	Rising action and middle scenes; dialogue craft
W5	Ch. 10-12; Top Hat compare: Ji-li at the start vs. the end	Mentor poem imitation; first original drafts	Learning logs to explanatory paragraphs; choose a brain topic	Climax and resolution drafted; first full draft due
W6	Finish memoir; Circle of Knowledge; objective summary	Drafting 2-3 more poems; figurative language workshop	Research week; gather and cite evidence; Circle of Knowledge	Revision cycle 1 (structural); peer conferences
W7	Personal narrative: drafting from a turning-point moment	Drafting and revision; peer feedback	Draft the explanatory piece; conferences begin	Revision cycle 2: sentences, dialogue, pacing
W8	Peer revision (W.5); sensory and precise language	Artist's statement; compile and design the collection	Revise for precise language, transitions, and structure	Line editing; grammar workshops on student drafts
W9	Polish, publish, and share	Poetry reading; final portfolio	Publish and present; reflect on writing to learn	Polish, publish, anthology, and reading celebration

 Quarter product production window  Text-anchored reading and response weeks

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Eighth Grade English Language Arts

WWII memoir, the first science fiction novel, Shakespeare in performance, and original fiction. Writing focus: sentences up through full essays and stories.

SCHEDULE

Tue · Thu · Fri

READING TARGET

~1,500 words / week

Q1

Going Solo & Personal Narrative

ANCHOR TEXT

Going Solo, Roald Dahl's RAF memoir, centered on the Battle of Athens.

PRODUCT

Personal narrative essay told from a meaningful true story, with a full revision cycle.

WORD STUDY

Dictionary skills; precise verbs and concrete detail in Dahl's prose.

RI.1-3

RI.6

W.3

W.5

SL.1

Reading for Meaning

Top Hat

Q2

Frankenstein & Science Fiction

ANCHOR TEXT

Mary Shelley's *Frankenstein*, the novel that launched the science fiction genre.

PRODUCT

An original science fiction story built on a real scientific idea taken one step too far.

WORD STUDY

Greek and Latin roots; gothic and scientific vocabulary.

RL.1-4

RL.6

W.3-5

L.4

Inductive Learning

Circle of Knowledge

Q3

Theater & Romeo and Juliet

ANCHOR TEXT

Shakespeare's *Romeo and Juliet*, studied as a play meant to be performed.

PRODUCT

Staged scene performances with director's notes, plus a drama response essay.

WORD STUDY

Figurative language; wordplay, puns, and Elizabethan English.

RL.4-5

RL.7

W.1

SL.4-6

L.5

Circle of Knowledge

Compare & Contrast

Q4

Story Writing Workshop

ANCHOR TEXT

Short fiction mentor texts studied in class as models of storytelling craft.

PRODUCT

An original multi-scene short story carried through planning, drafting, two revision cycles, and publication.

WORD STUDY

Grammar workshops run on student drafts: usage, conventions, style.

W.3-5

L.1-3

RL.3

SL.6

Write to Learn

Compare & Contrast

Grading Scale

A

B

C

D

F

88.5%+

78.5-88.4

68.5-78.4

58.5-68.4

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How Work Is Assessed

■ One weekly paper assignment, graded through one-on-one conferences with a revision window before grades finalize.

■ One polished quarter product, scored with element-by-element rubrics tied to each required sentence and paragraph.

■ Just Words unit tests, plus a midterm and final cumulative assessment (page 7).

Running all year: daily Morning Edit conventions practice, weekly homework in familiar Template A and Template B formats, independent reading journals, and the Wilson Just Words word study block in the second half of every period (sequence on page 7).

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05 · GRADE 8

Grade 8 Week by Week

Each quarter runs nine weeks: roughly six weeks anchored in the text, then a three-week production window for the quarter product. Cream-shaded rows mark the production window. Long texts are chunked and excerpted to keep weekly readings near the 25-minute target.

	QUARTER 1 Going Solo	QUARTER 2 Frankenstein	QUARTER 3 Romeo & Juliet	QUARTER 4 Story Workshop
W1	Launch; memoir vs. fiction; WWII context; pre-reading statements	Launch; gothic origins of science fiction; the frame narrative	Launch; Shakespeare's stage; how to read drama aloud	Story architecture: arc, scene, conflict; mentor text mini-lessons
W2	East Africa chapters; Dahl's voice; inductive vocab sort	The letters and ch. 1-4; ambition vocabulary (Greek & Latin roots)	Prologue and Act I; sonnet form; figurative language sort	Character building; voice and point-of-view experiments
W3	East Africa chapters; how Dahl characterizes real people	Creation and abandonment; the ethics of Victor's science	Act II; staging choices; comparing two performances of one scene	Setting and worldbuilding; opening scene drafted
W4	RAF flight training; Top Hat compare: Dahl the clerk vs. Dahl the pilot	The creature's tale; point-of-view shift; who is the monster?	Act III; the turning point; escalation of conflict	Rising action and middle scenes; dialogue craft
W5	The Battle of Athens; tension, pacing, and understatement	Finish the novel; Circle of Knowledge; theme and responsibility	Act IV; dramatic irony; the audience knows more than the characters	Climax and resolution drafted; first full draft due
W6	Finish memoir; Circle of Knowledge; objective summary	Science fiction conventions; mentor stories; pitch an original premise	Act V; Circle of Knowledge: who bears the blame?	Revision cycle 1 (structural); peer conferences
W7	Personal narrative essay: drafting from a meaningful true story	Draft the science fiction story; conferences begin	Scene performance prep; blocking and director's notes	Revision cycle 2: sentences, dialogue, pacing
W8	Peer revision (W.5); sensory and precise language	Revision and peer conferences; sharpen the scientific premise	Performances; draft the drama response essay	Line editing; grammar workshops on student drafts
W9	Polish, publish, and share	Polish and share at a science fiction story session	Revise and publish the response essay	Polish, publish, anthology, and reading celebration

 Quarter product production window  Text-anchored reading and response weeks

Wilson Just Words Word Study

Just Words is Wilson Language Training's accelerated, multisensory Tier 2 decoding and spelling curriculum for grades 4-12. It runs in the second half of every class period, in both grades, all year. The 14-unit sequence below paces the program across four quarters at roughly two weeks per unit, with flex weeks absorbing reteaching as assessment data demands.

INSIDE EVERY JUST WORDS SESSION

1 · Sound Drill Rapid multisensory review of sound-symbol correspondence.	2 · Concept Teaching Explicit instruction in the unit's syllable, spelling, or suffix concept.	3 · Word & Sentence Reading Controlled words, phrases, and high frequency words applied in connected text.	4 · Dictation Students encode sounds, words, and full sentences; spelling made automatic.
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UNIT SEQUENCE BY QUARTER

QUARTER 1 · W1-9 Closed Syllables	QUARTER 2 · W10-18 Multisyllabic & V-E	QUARTER 3 · W19-27 Open, R-Controlled	QUARTER 4 · W28-36 Vowel Teams & Schwa
WEEK 1 Placement & baseline spelling inventory	UNIT 5 Closed multisyllabic words	UNIT 8 Open syllables	UNIT 12 Long o & u vowel teams
UNIT 1 Digraphs	UNIT 6 Comparative & superlative suffixes	UNIT 9 R-controlled syllables	UNIT 13 Final stable syllable: consonant-le
UNIT 2 Blends in closed syllables	UNIT 7 Vowel-consonant-e syllables	UNIT 10 Adding suffixes to multisyllabic words	UNIT 14 Schwa & full syllable review
UNIT 3 Bonus letter rule; welded sounds	BONUS UNIT Cumulative concept consolidation	UNIT 11 Long a & e vowel teams	MILESTONE Final review & cumulative assessment (Units 1-14)
UNIT 4 Suffixes -s, -es, -ed, -ing	MILESTONE Midterm review & assessment (Units 1-7)		

Standards Coverage

Just Words carries the foundational reading band so the literature units can stay focused on grade-level analysis.

- **Core:** RF.2 phonemic awareness; RF.3 phonics, syllable types, and affixes; RF.4 fluency.
- **Core, grades 7-8:** L.2 spelling; L.4 Greek and Latin affixes and roots.
- **Partial:** L.1 through sentence dictation; L.6 high frequency words.

Pacing Notes

- Wilson's full-time model is 14 units over 30 weeks; this plan fits a 36-week year with built-in flex weeks.
- Unit boundaries move with mastery data from unit tests, not with the calendar.
- Morning Edit and unit vocabulary recycle Just Words patterns, so word study is reinforced outside the block.

Why word study in grades 7-8. Following the Simple View of Reading, comprehension is the product of word recognition and language comprehension. Just Words carries the word recognition strand for students with decoding and spelling gaps, while the core literature units carry vocabulary, knowledge, and analysis. Together they serve the whole reader, consistent with the Science of Reading principles that ground this curriculum.